Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Kenya Moves to Operationalise Cybersecurity Agency : TechMoran** — TechMoran, 5 November 2026 KENYA

  ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo named operationalising the National Cybersecurity Agency a priority at the Africa Cyber Defense Forum in Nairobi on 4 November 2026. The agency was established in 2026 to run the National Cybersecurity Operations Centre. He also cited closer coordination with other national cyber bodies and the Data Protection Commissioner. *Also under Cybersecurity and Digital sovereignty.*

Legislation and regulation

- **The February Case That Could End Africa's Internet Registry** — CircleID, 5 November 2026 AFRICA

  CircleID reports that the Supreme Court of Mauritius is expected to hear Cloud Innovation's petition to wind up AFRINIC again in February 2027. No published order fixes that date. The Technology Service Providers of Kenya has reportedly retained a barrister said to have acted for the petitioner. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **Banques, FinTech, monnaie électronique : la Côte d'Ivoire prépare une nouvelle réglementation** — Linfodrome, 5 November 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The National Assembly's economic and finance committee unanimously adopted a banking-regulation bill on 4 November 2026. It brings FinTechs and electronic-money operators into the banking law for the first time. The 258-article text also covers Islamic finance, BCEAO licensing powers, customer protection and bank resolution. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Data protection

- **UCC Considers Registering Children's SIM Cards to Strengthen Online Safety** — Nile Post, 5 November 2026 UGANDA

  The Uganda Communications Commission is considering asking parents to declare SIM cards used by their children. Operators would then keep databases of minors' SIMs for online-safety measures. No instrument or timetable has been named. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Revenue-sharing, data sovereignty concerns arise from Liberia ID card concession** — Biometric Update, 5 November 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberian lawmakers are reviewing a draft concession, valued at USD 52 million to 54.7 million, with OeSD International to upgrade the national biometric ID system. Reports say the company would take 65% of specified revenues and the government 35%. Critics also question where biometric data would be stored and who would hold the encryption keys. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Ghana must protect its data sovereignty — Commission** — Graphic Online, 5 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission proposed on 28 October 2026 that a copy of health, financial, energy and natural-resource data be kept in Ghana. Its executive director said Ghana has eight data centres and Africa fewer than 200, against more than 5,000 in the United States. He spoke at a lecture at GIMPA. *Also under Digital sovereignty and Data Storage.*

- **Air Botswana probes suspected cyberattack** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 BOTSWANA

  Air Botswana activated incident-response procedures after a suspected ransomware attack on 3 November 2026. Unauthorised access reached internal systems holding employee information. The airline said booking and flight-operations systems were unaffected and that it had begun meeting its Data Protection Act 2024 obligations. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

Regional collaboration

- **Numérique : les pays arabes misent sur la coopération pour réduire les écarts** — wearetech.africa, 5 November 2026 TUNISIA NORTH AFRICA

  A UN commission session in Tunis on 4 and 5 November 2026 discussed a second Arab Digital Agenda. Plans include a mid-term review by 2028, a regional digital-development report and an Arab observatory. ESCWA's executive secretary said networks cover about 95% of the Arab population, but only 70% use the internet. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **The February Case That Could End Africa's Internet Registry** — CircleID, 5 November 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **IEC tool flags misinformation spread on socials** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Electoral Commission reported 34 complaints on its Real411 platform ahead of the November 2026 municipal elections. X accounted for 58.8% of them and TikTok for 23.5%. The chief electoral officer cited videos of commission staff posted without context.

- **Revenue-sharing, data sovereignty concerns arise from Liberia ID card concession** — Biometric Update, 5 November 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Finance

Financial sustainability

- **Nigeria seeks digital ID project extension to roll out MOSIP-based infrastructure** — Biometric Update, 5 November 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria has asked the World Bank for a third extension of its ID4D project, to 31 December 2027, according to a restructuring paper. The priority is the new MOSIP-based identity system, whose contract was signed on 15 September. The paper also records unpaid enrolment partners and about 145 million enrolments at 14 September. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Safaricom H1 profit jumps 36% to $448m** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 KENYA ETHIOPIA

  Safaricom's net income rose 35.9% to KES 58.2 billion in the six months to 30 September 2026. M-PESA revenue grew 13.6% to KES 100.1 billion. Safaricom Ethiopia raised service revenue 71.6% and narrowed its EBITDA loss to KES 434.4 million. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and ICT Industry.*

- **Paratus Lesotho opens for business with Starlink** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 LESOTHO

  Paratus Group launched Paratus Lesotho, a joint venture with Real Image Lesotho, on 5 November 2026. It is an authorised Starlink reseller. It offers satellite connectivity to businesses outside fibre coverage. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **MTN Uganda profits rise as data slows** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 UGANDA

  MTN Uganda's profit after tax rose 21.2% to Ush571.2 billion in the nine months to 30 September 2026, as a one-off tax settlement in the prior year dropped out. Data revenue growth slowed to 7.8% in the third quarter, which the company attributed partly to unauthorised Wi-Fi resellers. It now expects full-year service revenue growth near 8.5%. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Helios Towers Raises 2026 Guidance After Record Tenancy Additions Across Africa and Middle East** — Tech Africa News, 5 November 2026 DRC TANZANIA MALAWI AFRICA

  Helios Towers added 3,435 tenancies in the nine months to 30 September 2026, its highest year-to-date total, bringing the portfolio to 35,379 tenancies. Revenue rose 13% to US$718.8 million. The company raised its full-year guidance to about 4,000 additions. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **Digital leapfrogging or digital divide? Internet penetration and structural transformation in Africa** — Digital Policy Regulation and Governance, 5 November 2026 AFRICA

  A journal study by Enock Mwakalila of Mzumbe University uses panel data on African countries to test whether digitalisation changes economic structure. It finds that higher internet penetration lowers agriculture's share of output and raises that of services. The effect is stronger in slower-growing economies. *Also under Digital divides.*

Data Storage

- **Ghana must protect its data sovereignty — Commission** — Graphic Online, 5 November 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Cybersecurity

- **Cybersécurité : Abidjan devient le QG américain pour sécuriser l'Afrique de l'Ouest** — Linfodrome, 5 November 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Cybastion and Cisco inaugurated a Security Operations Centre in Abidjan on 5 November 2026, described as a regional hub for West Africa. A related programme aims to train 200,000 learners in cybersecurity, networking and AI by 2030. A US State Department official attended and cited USD 170 million of new US investment in Côte d'Ivoire in 2026. *Also under Training and skills and US / hyperscaler activities.*

- **Central Bank and National Communication Authority sign MoU on digital security** — One Citizen Daily, 5 November 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

The Bank of South Sudan and the National Communication Authority signed an updated memorandum on digital financial services on 4 November 2026. It revises their 2018 agreement. It provides for information sharing, joint supervision and enforcement, and stronger consumer protection and cybersecurity. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **UCC Considers Registering Children's SIM Cards to Strengthen Online Safety** — Nile Post, 5 November 2026 UGANDA

  Summarised under Data protection.

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  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Air Botswana probes suspected cyberattack** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 BOTSWANA

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DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Nedbank gears up for smart ID rollout** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Nedbank announced a phased rollout of Home Affairs smart-ID services at its branches. It begins with its own staff in November 2026, then nine pilot sites, and reaches all nine provinces in early 2027. Integration with Home Affairs systems is under test, and the fee is waived during the pilot.

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Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Safaricom makes more from M-PESA overdrafts as borrower numbers surge** — TechCabal, 5 November 2026 KENYA

  Safaricom said Fuliza, its M-PESA overdraft service, earned KES 4.9 billion in the six months to September 2026, up 86%. Borrowers reached 17.2 million, while the average advance fell 24.6% to KES 192. Fuliza supplied about 71% of revenue from Safaricom's six lending products. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **RDC: l'UE et le PNUD accompagnent la digitalisation de la justice pour renforcer la transparence et améliorer les services aux justiciables** — ACTUALITE.CD, 5 November 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's Ministry of Justice launched digital collection of court fees on 5 November 2026, with the courts, prosecutors' offices and prisons to be interconnected. UNDP provides technical support and the EU funds it. The first digital nationality certificate was issued at the launch, and a second phase is planned for early 2027. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Paga expands Direct Debit access for businesses beyond its network** — TechCabal, 5 November 2026 NIGERIA

  Paga now lets businesses collect direct debits from customers of other Nigerian financial institutions through Paga Engine, using existing interbank rails. TechCabal reported it on 5 November 2026. Central Bank of Nigeria data show 157.4 million direct-debit transactions worth about ₦23.3 trillion in 2024.

- **Interswitch deepens Uganda's digital banking reach** — ITWeb Africa, 5 November 2026 UGANDA

  Housing Finance Bank joined Interswitch's Quickteller agency banking network in Uganda on 4 November 2026. Customers can deposit, withdraw by card and check balances at more than 23,000 agents. The bank said its pilot had processed over UGX49 billion. *Also under Access to services.*

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Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **إطلاق منصة رقمية لمتابعة أسعار المواد الاستهلاكية ووفرتها** — Echorouk El Yawmi, 5 November 2026 ALGERIA

  Prime Minister Sifi Ghrieb launched a digital platform on 5 November 2026 to track the daily prices and availability of basic goods in every wilaya. It is meant to trace goods along the national supply chain. He announced it to the walis by videoconference.

- **Burkina/Économie : La DGI renforce les capacités de ses agents pour accélérer sa digitalisation** — leFaso.net, 5 November 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Burkina Faso's tax directorate began training more than 400 agents on 4 November 2026 in three digital systems: e-filing, certified e-invoicing and the online cadastre. Sessions are held in four cities. The DISMEFIP project, co-funded by Swiss cooperation and the government, pays for it. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **RDC: l'UE et le PNUD accompagnent la digitalisation de la justice pour renforcer la transparence et améliorer les services aux justiciables** — ACTUALITE.CD, 5 November 2026 DRC

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Technology

AI

- **Somalia to establish AI Academy** — Connecting Africa, 5 November 2026 SOMALIA

Tabaarak ICT Solutions and the Somali National Artificial Intelligence Centre signed an agreement to set up an AI academy in Mogadishu. It is to offer continuous training, courses, research and internships. No funding, start date or intake has been stated. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Robotique et IA : le Gabon explore des technologies chinoises pour moderniser ses services** — wearetech.africa, 5 November 2026 GABON

  President Brice Clotaire Oligui Nguema visited a robotics park in Shanghai on 4 November 2026, during a state visit to China. The presidency named training, technology transfer and public-service uses as possible areas of cooperation. Gabon's first national AI strategy has not yet been adopted. *Also under China activities.*

ICT Industry

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Innovation ecosystem

- **SA's ICT sector records largest increase in R&D spend** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The National R&D Survey for 2024/25 puts South Africa's ICT research spending at R5.7 billion, up R853 million, the largest rise of any field. Total R&D spending was R44.2 billion, and intensity fell from 0.62% to 0.60% of GDP. Business R&D fell by R742 million. *Also under Research institutions.*

Capacity

Training and skills

- **Digify Africa brings digital training to unemployed youth via WhatsApp** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Digify Africa launched the Didi Mobile Academy, a WhatsApp digital-skills course for South Africans aged 18 to 35. The Trevor Noah Foundation's R50 million Kulaninati Innovation Fund pays for it. The first course has five modules of about 15 minutes each. *Also under Digital divides.*

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  Summarised under AI.

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Research institutions

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  Summarised under Innovation ecosystem.

Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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  Summarised under Training and skills.

Data

Geospatial data

- **SAP018: Enhancing Climate Information Systems for Resilient Development in Liberia (Liberia CIS)** — Green Climate Fund, 5 November 2026 LIBERIA

  The Green Climate Fund approved project SAP018 on 13 November 2020, with the African Development Bank as accredited entity. It funds climate information and early-warning services in Liberia, aiming to reach 7.7 million people. The grant is USD 10 million of a USD 11.4 million total, and completion is set for October 2027.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

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Digital sovereignty

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.